

ROSE BAKLAVA

INGREDIENTS

500gms mixed nuts (walnut & almond)

1 teaspoon ground cinnamon
1 package phyllo dough
1 cup butter, melted

1 cup white sugar
1 cup water
3tbsp rose water
1/2 cup honey
1 teaspoon vanilla extract
1 teaspoon grated lemon zest

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 175 degrees C. Butter a 9x13 inch baking dish.
2. Place the nuts and the cinnamon into a food processor and pulse until a fine texture, but do not overwork
3. Unroll phyllo and cut whole stack in half to fit the dish. Cover phyllo with a damp cloth while assembling the baklava, to keep it from drying out.
4. Place two sheets of phyllo in the bottom of the prepared dish. Brush generously with butter. Sprinkle 2 to 3 tablespoons of the nut mixture on top. Repeat layers until all ingredients are used, ending with about 6 sheets of phyllo. Using a sharp knife, cut baklava (all the way through to the bottom of the dish) into four long rows, then (nine times) diagonally to make 36 diamond shapes.
5. Bake in preheated oven 50 minutes, until golden and crisp.
6. While baklava is baking, combine sugar and water in a small saucepan over medium heat and bring to a boil. Stir in honey, vanilla and lemon zest, reduce heat and simmer 20 minutes, once reduced add the rose water.
7. Remove the baklava from the oven and immediately spoon the syrup over it. Let cool completely before serving.
8. Store uncovered.

THE
COOKERY

by The Secret Jozi Chef